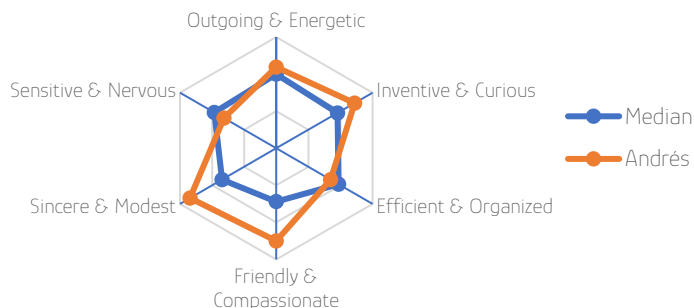


Andrés Peña Castillo

ID: 1-1637-0246
Heredia, Costa Rica

Personality:
ENTP

(+506) 8945-6736
lapc506@gmail.com



Behavior, Thought, and Emotion Patterns (HEXACO model)

About Myself

Leaving a Lasting Legacy is my Driver.

Helping others get access to the opportunities I had is my purpose.

I'm CTO and co-founder of the following startups:

- Vertivo (AgriTech + AI for plant pathology detection): founded in 2021, incubated with [Bridge for Billions](#) and [Auge-UCR](#), raised a pre-seed round of US \$9.500 in 2022.
- Keiko (EdTech + Self-Study Guides AI + Learning Blockchain): founded in 2025, enrolled in [Starknet Hackathon](#), self-funded
- AltruPets (GovTech SaaS for animal rescue + crowdfunding): founded in 2025, self-funded

I've established and managed in-real-life and online communities:

- "[Ciencia de Datos en Latinoamérica](#)" – group owner in LinkedIn – started since Jul. 2019 – approx. 3.000 members in Oct. 2025
- "[Startups 506](#)" – co-founded in Nov. 2022 – actively co-administered since Mar. 2022 until Apr. 2024
- "[Flutter Apps en Latinoamérica](#)" – group owner in LinkedIn – started in Aug. 2025 – under 100 members in Oct. 2025

Hobbies:

electronic dance music festivals, karts and formula 1, travelling to explore natural wonders, enjoying spicy food!

Career Path

Areas of Expertise	Site Reliability Engineering (Cloud and Clusters Management, DevOps)		Patch Management and Endpoints Administration (Windows, macOS, Android, iOS)	
Areas of Interest	Machine Learning, Computer Vision and Data Engineering	Flutter & Dart for Multi-Platform App Development	User Experience Research & Design	Forensic Analysis & Cybersecurity
Language Domain	English (C1)	Spanish (native)	Portuguese (A2) (Listening and Reading)	studying Japanese and German

Cloud Engineering Certificates

Certified Kubernetes Application Developer	2025/Q1	In Progress	Due to pass CKAD certification exam
--	---------	-------------	---

Other Professional Certificates

PIEA 2023 - Acceleration and Mentoring of Agro-Industrial Business Projects –INCAE Business School Executive Education & Invermaster Ventures	2023/07	Obtained Attendance Cert.	ID: 78890619 Online Acceleration Program for Early-Stage Startups
Innovate Programme 2022 – Friedrich Naumann Stiftung für die Freiheit	2022/11	Obtained Diploma	Online Incubation Program for Early-Stage Startups
The Leap Incubation Program – Bridge for Billions	2021/05	Obtained Diploma	Online Incubation Program for Early-Stage Startups
Scrum Product Owner – CertiProf	2020/07	Obtained SPOPC	ID: TLSZKKKDGL-MHWXHXTH-RPFLPHFFJJ
User Stories Foundation – CertiProf	2020/07	Obtained USFC	ID: FLCLQCCDJT-SDKLFGJD-WHKQQDFHZK
Scrum Foundation Professional – CertiProf	2020/06	Obtained SPFC	ID: CLVSNFNYY-SSZVVKZV-XHRHTCMTTP
English for Speakers of Other Languages – University of Cambridge	2013/11	Obtained B1	Common European Framework of Reference for Languages – Official B1 English Level Certification
Cisco IT Essentials – Fundación Omar Dengo & Cisco Networking Academy	2011/11	Obtained Diploma	Technical degree obtained at Flores Technical H.S.

Professional Workshops

Management 3.0 Fundamentals	2020/06	ID: 200657724	Due to obtain degree from Practitioner exam
Tableau 2019.2 Intermediate	2019/08	On-premises	Due to obtain degree from Associate exam

Last edited: 29/9/2025 01:07:00

Soft Skills				
Teamwork & Democratic Leadership	Self-Learning	Data-driven Decision Maker	Attention to Details	Persuasiveness
Empathy & Rapport Building	Dialectic & Maieutic Reasoning	<u>Anti-Fragility</u>	Assertive & Non-violent Communication	Timeboxing
Hard Skills				
Site Reliability Engineering, DevSecOps, and Artificial Intelligence	Containerization: <u>Red Hat OpenShift</u> , <u>Kubernetes</u> , <u>Minikube</u> , <u>Podman Desktop</u> , <u>WSL2</u> , <u>GitHub Container Registry</u> ★★★★★	Automation: <u>Ansible</u> , <u>AWX</u> , <u>PowerShell</u> , <u>Bash</u> , <u>Python</u> ; <u>Linux administration</u> ★★★★★	Observability (Cloud): <u>IBM Instana</u> , <u>Grafana</u> , <u>Datadog</u> , <u>Mezmo</u> , <u>AWS CloudWatch</u> , <u>AWS Resource Explorer</u> ★★★★★	Cloud Compute: <u>AWS EC2</u> , <u>Amazon Machine Images</u> , <u>Auto Scaling groups</u> ★★★★★
	GitOps & CI/CD: <u>ArgoCD Tools</u> , <u>Kubectx & Kubens</u> , <u>Helm chart templates</u> , <u>OpenShift CI/CD</u> , <u>GitHub Actions</u> , <u>GitFlow</u> ★★★★	Infrastructure-as-Code: <u>Terraform</u> & <u>AWS CloudFormation</u> ★★★★	<u>AWS Identity and Access Management</u> : Users, Roles, Groups, Policies, Permissions ★★★★	Spec-Driven AI Coding: <u>Kiro.dev Specs</u> , <u>Cursor Rules</u> , <u>Gemini CLI Context Files</u> , <u>GitHub Spec Kit</u> , <u>Warp Rules</u> , <u>MCPs in LM Studio</u> ★★★★
	AWS Event Streams: <u>IoT Core</u> , <u>SQS</u> , <u>SNS</u> ★★	AWS Serverless: <u>Lambda</u> , <u>Step Functions</u> & <u>Application Composer</u> ★★	VPCs: <u>Route 53</u> , <u>subnets</u> , <u>Internet & NAT gateways</u> , <u>network ACLs</u> , <u>security groups</u> ★★	MLOps for LLMs & VisionLMs: <u>LangChain</u> , <u>LangGraph</u> , <u>LangSmith</u> , <u>LangFuse</u> , <u>AWS SageMaker</u> , <u>Google Vertex AI</u> , <u>Apache Airflow</u> , <u>Kubeflow</u> , <u>MLFlow</u> , <u>cvtk</u> , <u>OpenCV</u> ★
Systems Administration	Vulnerability and Patch Management: <u>ManageEngine Endpoint Central</u> & <u>WSUS</u> ★★★★★	LDAP Management: <u>Active Directory</u> & <u>Group Policy Management</u> (including <u>AGPM</u>) ★★★★★	Incident & Change Management (ITIL v3): <u>Salesforce Lightning</u> , <u>ServiceNow ITSM</u> & <u>JIRA</u> ★★★★★	Windows Administration: <u>Tanium</u> , <u>BigFix DEV</u> & <u>MS SCCM Software Center</u> ★★★★★
	Windows 11 Troubleshooting: <u>Windows Performance Toolkit</u> , <u>Regedit</u> , <u>Event Viewer</u> , <u>CMTrace</u> ★★★★★	macOS Management: <u>Jamf Pro</u> & <u>Apple DEP</u> ★★★★★	Hardware Virtualization: <u>VMWare Horizon 7</u> (<u>App Volumes</u> & <u>UEM</u>) ★★★★★	Endpoints Monitoring: <u>Nextthink Collector</u> , <u>Splunk</u> & <u>Dynatrace</u> ★★★★★
	SAML SSO Management: <u>Okta</u> , <u>Entrust</u> , <u>Duo</u> & <u>Microsoft Authenticator</u> ★★★★★	OS Imaging and Cloning: <u>Microsoft Deployment Toolkit</u> ★★★★	E-mail Management: <u>Exchange Server 2019</u> , <u>Outlook for Office 365</u> ★★	VPN Troubleshooting: <u>Pulse Secure</u> & <u>Cisco AnyConnect</u> ★★★
Projects Management & Leadership	Agile Project Management: <u>ClickUp</u> , <u>Notion</u> , <u>JIRA</u> , <u>Confluence</u> ★★★★★	Product Ownership: <u>Scrum</u> & <u>User Story Mapping</u> ★★★★	<u>Lean Business Canvas</u> & <u>Design Thinking</u> ★★	<u>Management 3.0</u> ★★
UX & UI Research & Design	Mobile Apps Development: <u>Flutter</u> (Dart, Riverpod, Rive) ★★★★	UI Product Design: <u>Figma</u> , <u>Zeplin.io</u> , <u>InVision Studio</u> ★★	AI Frontend Builders: <u>Lovable</u> , <u>Base44</u> , <u>Bolt</u> ★★	Low-Code Frontend Builders: <u>Webflow</u> , <u>Elementor</u> ★★
Data	Analytics: <u>Tableau Desktop</u> , <u>Looker Studio</u> ★★★★	Pivot/Dynamic Tables: <u>MS Excel</u> , <u>Google Sheets</u> ★★★★	Reporting: <u>Microsoft Power BI (DAX)</u> ★★	Data Science: <u>KNIME Analytics</u> , <u>Alteryx</u> ★

Full-Time Work Experience	
IBM	Hybrid, American Free Zone, Heredia, CR
Site Reliability Engineer; <i>Maximo Application Suite and Maximo Manage</i>	(Feb. 2024 – Sept. 2025)
Responsibilities	Achievements
- Administering Red Hat OpenShift on several clusters in AWS: Modifying manually OpenShift YAML manifests from Custom Resource Definitions and operators. - Administering IBM WebSphere (WAS) on several RHEL servers. - Deploying MAS application upgrades using ArgoCD workflows. - Observing MAS applications using IBM Instana and Grafana. - Composing runbooks and knowledge base articles on GitHub Pages and Atlassian Confluence. - Providing Incident Real-Time Response using IBM On Call Manager, PagerDuty and Salesforce Lightning, and researching Root Causes.	- Successfully built multiple Bash scripts for Red Hat OpenShift and IBM WebSphere (WAS) for task automation and apps data retrieval - Cleaned up several out-of-date runbooks in Confluence. - Successfully supported multiple Maximo major upgrades, incl. from MAS 8 to 9.1, from 9.0 to 9.1.2. - Supported and documented a Disaster Recovery scenario for Db2U Standalone running on OpenShift clusters (May 13th, 2024). - Became familiarized with SQL and NoSQL dialects: IBM DB2, Oracle, and MongoDB/Amazon DocumentDB.

Last edited: 29/9/2025 01:07:00

Provectus

IT Cloud Engineer; *Consulting contractor for Model N*

Full-time Remote, Heredia, CR

(Sept. 2021 – Nov. 2023)

Responsibilities

- Provide advanced support for ManageEngine Desktop Central & Jamf Cloud management suites.
- Develop automatic Patch Management workflows to manage inbound monthly patches for Microsoft Windows and Mac OS X systems.
- Document brand new company policies to preserve a good overall patch management health in the client's ecosystem.
- Develop custom PowerShell scripts for scheduling System Restore Points, blocking Windows 11 updates based on client's needs, and root cause analysis of patch deployment failures.
- Work with internal customers scheduling time for one-to-one assistance in creating corporate data backups with MS OneDrive, generating self-service training and internal documentation in Jira & Confluence.
- Built several project management sub-tasks in Jira.

Achievements

- Successfully upgraded +1,100 endpoints from Windows 10 version 1703 and later up to the latest version 21H2 (as of August 2022).
- Built a brand-new business process to schedule regular update deployments monthly ("Automated Patch Deployments") for Windows 10 endpoints using ManageEngine Endpoint Central.
- There were four groups set into place for each stage: A0 for Test and Approval, A1 for Staging, A2 for QA, and A3 for Production.
- Successfully implemented manual major upgrades to MacBooks running macOS Monterey 12.5; these were upgraded to macOS Ventura 13.6 deploying Nudge via Jamf Cloud, this was successfully implemented for both Intel-based and Apple Silicon-based Macs using a customized Bash script forked from a MacAdmins community resource.
- Successfully cleaned up +400 decommissioned endpoints off ManageEngine Endpoint Central, ManageEngine Asset Explorer, and MS Active Directory to prevent false positives computers running Win10 from showing up in Missing Patches asset management and inventory reports.
- Documented several procedure guidelines and corporate policies to allow my client to continue supporting the automated and manual update deployments for Windows 10 endpoints and MacBooks.
- Successfully implemented manual upgrades to Mac OS X Monterey 12.5 building official Apple images and tested deploying them via Jamf Cloud.

Roche Services & Solutions (F. Hoffmann-La Roche Ltd.)

Senior Service Desk Agent

San Rafael, Escazú, San José, CR

(Sept. 2020 – Sept. 2021)

Responsibilities

- Create IT incidents and requests received via multiple channels (telephone, email, chat, self-service portal, ticketing application or others).
- Manage the classification, assignment, tracking, and completion of service requests and incident tickets in ServiceNow ITSM according to Incident Management and Problem Management processes (based on ITIL3 framework), ensuring that resolutions are consistent with corporate global standards and processes.
- Provide first level support for incidents for Roche applications related to the Google Suite, Microsoft Office, SAP, internal and proprietary apps such as Document Management tools (e.g., touchpoint, CoreMap), Conferencing tools (Webex, Google Meet), and Mac OS X applications; all aligned with global and regional practices (for South San Francisco, California; Indianapolis, Indiana; and other Roche HQ locations).
- Provide first level support for Roche approved standard, and exception, hardware (laptops, desktops, tablets, mobile phones/devices, monitors, and printers), and assistance for hardware (HW) requests per knowledge articles by location/site of end user.
- Assist with software requests.
- Follow appropriate troubleshooting processes as per knowledge articles.
- Ensure end users are informed about tickets progress.
- Manage end user expectations.

Achievements

- Implemented a custom problem analysis reporting tool for continuous improvement, using my own knowledge and background to systemize root cause analysis for suggesting proactive change recommendations in the internal troubleshooting knowledge articles from the Roche IT Service Desk. This reporting tool (manually built in Google Sheets using filters and Pivot Tables) was used by my manager and coaches to track down common mistakes from myself and other colleagues to improve feedback assessments during Quality Assurance sessions. I demonstrated how this tool could be used by self-assessing my own troubleshooting, by manually reviewing my QA-flagged tickets and delivering improvements on my own KPI progress. My manager decided to implement a pilot of this tool during September 2020 for other ex-teammates at the Service Desk in Costa Rica right after I left Roche and accepted a new offer to begin working at Provectus.
- Supported other colleagues via Google Chat regarding advanced topics that required deep technical understanding of Windows (such as Registry keys and values) and learned valuable lessons about Mac OS X troubleshooting thanks to other colleagues.
- Became familiarized with troubleshooting Mac OS X, iPhones and iPads using Jamf Cloud.
- Worked along our Knowledge Manager to ensure all the Knowledge Base articles archived in ServiceNow were still relevant, up to date, and properly addressed the resolution of the most common and the most unlikely scenarios, also composed several new articles.

Last edited: 29/9/2025 01:07:00

- Escalate incident/service tickets that cannot be resolved at 1st level to 2nd level SMEs as per knowledge article's each assigned service owner.
- Instruct end users on how to best use Roche tools and services as part of ongoing support during end user interactions.
- Build and properly document technical expertise.
- Drive overall customer satisfaction through individual and departmental KPIs and process alignments.
- Act upon feedback from quality reviews to impact direct support resolution more effectively.

Western Union	
End User Support Specialist, EUC Desktop Engineering (Level 3 Support)	
Responsibilities	Achievements
• Keep computers up to date through WSUS. • Build PowerShell scripts to create new install packages, planning their mass distribution and installation via Tanium. • Review vulnerabilities previously detected in Qualys VMDR, and error alerts in Pulse Secure. • Trace down Windows OS system errors via the Event Viewer, using CMTrace to interpret source log files. • Change Management process via ServiceNow. • Deploy new apps using VMWare Horizon, installation was done via AppStacks and customization via User Environment Manager. • Send a monthly e-mail newsletter for IT teammates with a complete list of all Windows Updates released during each new WSUS deployment.	• Successfully translated legacy batch scripts originally built for installing several corporate apps, into PowerShell 5.1, allowing Western Union to complete its migration from the legacy IBM BigFix system to the new Tanium implementation made in 2019. • Successfully detected the root cause for Windows Update failures affecting over 1.000 endpoints across Latin America and some USA states in 2019. Alongside my previous manager, we found together a database records corruption on the corporate WSUS servers, these were later reestablished by Microsoft expert engineers themselves, due to the extent of the damages that had to be manually repaired. • Successfully deployed the first AppStacks images versions that were used in the VMWare Horizon environment for third-party contractors belonging to Cloud Operations, Software Development and Data Analysis. My previous studies in Tableau and Power BI allowed me to reach a better understanding of the technical issues impacting my end-users due to a <u>Tableau incompatibility with the Horizon platform running non-persistent desktops</u>. • Successfully configured the testing environment for the Patch Management module in Tanium prior to its Production release. • Successfully upgraded the main IBM BigFix server used to update Win10 endpoints located in Kroger's retail stores across all the United States. • Successfully discovered in 2018 <u>an unexpected bug</u> (causing error code 0x80070070 in Windows Update Agent on the Win10 affected endpoints) on the October 2018 Feature upgrade rolled out by Microsoft. Rolled back the changes for several endpoints successfully. <u>After a new upgrade package was released</u>, not all computers could be restored to a healthy state, therefore a new corporate policy was set in place to implement System Restore Points for all Windows 10 endpoints and impacted laptops were scheduled to get re-imaged. • Worked along InfoSec colleagues to proactively patch vulnerabilities found with Qualys VMDR.

Western Union	
Technical Support Technician, Help Desk (Level 1 Support)	
Responsibilities	Achievements
• Support end users addressing technology incidents and request, escalate issues and cooperate with next tier IT teams to find a solution. • Support IT outages as per Business Continuity Plan. • Support the following standard business apps: SailPoint, Active Directory, Okta SSO, IBM OnDemand, IBM AS400, MS Outlook, VMware Horizon 7 VDIs and Pulse Secure VPN authentication, among several proprietary apps from my employer.	• Worked along my End User Computing Technician (Level 2 Support) colleagues to resolve complex issues that other L1 team members were not aware on how to solve, thanks to prior knowledge acquired back in 2013 and during 2016. • Updated several Knowledge Base documentation articles in ServiceNow ITSM.

Hewlett Packard Enterprise (a.k.a. DXC Technology since Apr. 2018)

Customer Solution Center Technician, Pfizer Global Service Desk

American Free Zone, Heredia, CR

(Nov. 2015 – Dec. 2016)

Responsibilities

- Support RightFax at the Pfizer Printing Support Team, configuring the internal BIOS within the several HP printers deployed across the Pfizer buildings.
- Raised major incidents affecting Pfizer on a larger scale, including some outages in New York HQ.
- Create IT incidents and requests received via multiple channels (telephone, email, chat, self-service portal, ticketing application or others).
- Manage the classification, assignment, tracking, and completion of service requests and incident tickets in ServiceNow ITSM according to Incident Management and Problem Management processes (based on ITIL3 framework), ensuring that resolutions are consistent with corporate global standards and processes.
- Quickly adapt to fast corporate changes.

Achievements

- I was successful at getting promoted to the Printing Support team. Originally, I belonged to the Global Service Desk customer account Pfizer: we were not only the Help Desk L1 team, but also the Printing and Global Account Administration teams.
- My biggest collaboration occurred once I had to communicate with L2 and L3 teams, this occurred on a Sunday morning in early 2016, that day all Pfizer collaborators were working remotely, and the Cisco AnyConnect VPN system experienced a global outage. Later I helped the VPN support team to detect that the actual Oracle database supporting the VPN service had also went blacked out, so I had to reach out to this team as well.

Perfiles Tecnológicos

Technical Support Representative; Contractor for HPE at Pfizer GSD

American Free Zone, Heredia, CR

(Dec. 2014 – Nov. 2015)

Responsibilities

- Create IT incidents and requests received via multiple channels (telephone, email, chat, self-service portal, ticketing application or others).
- Manage the classification, assignment, tracking, and completion of service requests and incident tickets in ServiceNow ITSM according to Incident Management and Problem Management processes (based on ITIL3 framework), ensuring that resolutions are consistent with corporate global standards and processes.
- Quickly adapt to fast corporate changes.

Achievements

- Successfully supported the transition to Windows 8, then to Windows 8.1, for most Pfizer computers that were still running Windows XP until 2015.
- Successfully supported the integration efforts of migrating Hospira colleagues after Pfizer completed their acquisition (prior to their subsequent split and rebranding into "IHS Medical"), those users were running Windows 7 on a separate AD domain.
- Built a custom marquee-style tool using HTML5 and jQuery to help my team reduce loud environmental noise during IT outages, this improved the satisfaction rate across multiple accounts (not only Pfizer, but it was also deployed at Universal Music Group, Grupo Bimbo, and Under Armour local accounts at HPE).
- Became familiarized with Active Directory and other management apps such as Citrix XenApp for Virtual Desktops, and MobileIron for MDM.

Western Union

Internship, End User Computing Technician (Level 2 Support)

FORUM2 Free Zone, San José, CR

(Oct. 2013 – Nov. 2013)

Responsibilities

- Support end users addressing IT hardware and software incidents for Windows 7 laptops & desktops.
- Assist in updating local asset inventory bookkeeping.

Achievements

- Learned how to interact with, and support, end users physically on their desk and remotely via Bomgar.
- Learned how to deploy Windows images via PXE boot.

Entrepreneurship

Vertivo (Costa Rican urban vertical farming start-up)

Chief Technology Officer, Co-Founder

Guararí, Heredia, CR

(May. 2021 – present date, 2025)

- Our startup was founded in the middle of the COVID-19 pandemic to solve a food scarcity, pesticide neurotoxicity and supply chain problems that are bound to impact Costa Rica in the upcoming 5 years.
- Successfully raised pre-seed round of ₡5.880.000 (approximately US \$9.500-\$10.000).
- Hired one freelance marketing director in 2022.

Volunteering

Asociación de Emprendedores de Costa Rica (ASECRI)

Systemic Change Agent for Startup Ecosystem

San José, CR

(Aug. 2022 – Apr. 2024)

- "Strengthening of the Entrepreneurial & Innovation Ecosystem in Costa Rica" project

Asociación de Desarrollo Integral de Guararí

Local "CECI" Community Manager for MICITT National Program

Guararí, Heredia, CR

(Jul. 2022 – present date, 2022)

- Costa Rican national-wide volunteering program deployed since 2006 by MICITT (*Science, Innovation, Technology and Telecom Ministry*).
- CECIs are computer laboratories installed on a national network of communities under agreements with NGOs, private and public colleges, and other institutions, where free computer and digital literacy courses are provided to communities, virtually, in person and bimodal.

Freelance Work Experience

FX Entrepreneurs (now defunct)

Foreign Exchange Broker - Project Manager

Sabana Sur, San José, CR

(Dec. 2019 – Feb. 2020)

- Built a Technical Feasibility Study for a white-label implementation of FX Aggregator software with Liquidity Gateway services included (*using B2Broker's solution, LMAX Exchange, Fortex Bridge OMX, Brokeree, etc.*).

Moovin (Costa Rican last-mile logistics start-up)

Tableau Data Analyst

Escazú, San José, CR

(Apr. 2019 – Jun. 2019)

IT Designers (now defunct)

Windows Server 2012 Administrator

Guadalupe, San José, CR

(Sept. 2016 – Dec. 2016)

Formal Education Degrees

Instituto Tecnológico de Costa Rica

Computer Sciences Engineering Bachelors' degree (in Hiatus)

Barrio Amón, San José, CR

(Feb. 2014 – Jun. 2015)

Colegio Técnico Profesional de Flores

Information Technology Technical Support degree

Bachelorship in Secondary Education

San Joaquín, Flores, Heredia, CR

(Feb. 2011 – Dec. 2013)

(Feb. 2011 – Dec. 2013)